

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF LIBRARIAN UNDER LAW & JUDICIAL DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM (JULY-2026)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A (Multiple Choice Questions) (66 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1.

*This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 5): In these questions, four alternatives are given for the underlined idioms/phrases in the sentences. Choose the alternative which best expresses the meaning:

1. The new policy has become a **bone of contention** among the stakeholders.
(a) Source of agreement (b) Matter of dispute
(c) Cause of celebration (d) Topic of research
2. The auditor's report **pulled no punches** in criticizing the institution's financial practices.
(a) Avoided criticism (b) Remained neutral
(c) Praised selectively (d) Criticized frankly and forcefully
3. The proposal was accepted because it **cut the Gordian knot** of administrative complexity.
(a) Created further confusion (b) Solved a difficult problem decisively
(c) Avoided a challenge (d) Complicated the procedure
4. The issue remained **a moot point** despite prolonged discussion.
(a) A settled matter (b) A controversial but irrelevant matter
(c) A debatable or unresolved issue (d) A legal requirement
5. To **cross the Rubicon** means:
(a) Pass a point of no return (b) Reach a compromise
(c) Return to safety (d) Begin negotiations

Direction (Question Nos. 6 - 10): In the following questions, out of the four alternatives, choose the one which can be substituted for the given words/sentences:

6. To die without making a will.
(a) Inane (b) Indigent
(c) Inure (d) Intestate
7. Highly skilled
(a) Consummate (b) Inveterate
(c) Notorious (d) Maladroit

8. Insatiable desire for wealth
(a) Selfish (b) Avarice
(c) Egoist (d) Generosity
9. People who habitually seek and enjoy the company of others.
(a) Austere (b) Gregarious
(c) Morose (d) Diffident
10. Showing poor taste and quality.
(a) Urbane (b) Pristine
(c) Tawdry (d) Austere

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 15): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate form of the verbs given:

11. By the time the audit report was submitted, the committee _____ (review) the financial records for nearly six months.
(a) reviewed (b) had reviewed
(c) had been reviewing (d) has reviewed
12. By next January, the researcher _____ (work) on this project for fifteen years.
(a) will work (b) will have worked
(c) will be working (d) will have been working
13. For the last ten years, the institution _____ remarkable progress in digital archiving.
(a) made (b) has made
(c) had made (d) will make
14. Neither of the explanations _____ entirely convincing.
(a) seems (b) seem
(c) are seeming (d) have seemed
15. The committee expects that, by the end of the year, the institution _____ all regulatory requirements.
(a) satisfies (b) will satisfy
(c) will have satisfied (d) satisfied

Direction (Question Nos. 16 - 20): Identify the correct notion expressed by each of the following sentences by choosing one of the alternatives given:

16. Would that I had accepted the offer when it was first made!
(a) Exclamatory (b) Imperative
(c) Optative (d) Declarative
17. It is requested that all members be present at the meeting.
(a) Imperative (b) Declarative
(c) Negative (d) Interrogative
18. You will kindly refrain from using mobile phones in the library.
(a) Imperative (b) Declarative
(c) Optative (d) Negative

19. She is not only intelligent but also hardworking.
(a) Negative (b) Optative
(c) Interrogative (d) Affirmative
20. He never speaks anything but the truth.
(a) Affirmative (b) Negative
(c) Interrogative (d) Declarative

Direction (Question Nos. 21- 25): Out of the four alternatives, choose the one which states the kind of clause of the underlined word or phrase:

21. We believe that truth always wins.
(a) Non-finite clause (b) Finite clause
(c) Adjective phrase (d) Infinitive clause
22. Having finished the assignment, he went out to play.
(a) Finite clause (b) Noun clause
(c) Adverb clause (d) Non-finite clause
23. What he said yesterday was completely unexpected.
(a) Noun clause (b) Adjective clause
(c) Adverb clause (d) Infinitive clause
24. Anyone who breaks the rules will be punished.
(a) Noun clause (b) Adverb clause
(c) Adjective clause (d) Non-finite clause
25. You can go wherever you like.
(a) Adjective clause (b) Adverb clause
(c) Noun clause (d) Gerund clause

Direction (Question Nos. 26 - 30): Out of the four alternatives, choose the one which best expresses the same meaning in Direct/Indirect Speech:

26. He said, "Please open the window."
(a) He requested to open the window. (b) He asked that the window be opened.
(c) He ordered that the window is opened. (d) He told please open the window.
27. She said, "I wish I were rich."
(a) She said that she wishes she was rich. (b) She said that she wished she had been rich.
(c) She said that she wished she were rich. (d) She said that she wishes she were rich.
28. They said, "We will have completed the project by tomorrow."
(a) They said that they would have completed the project by the next day.
(b) They said that they will have completed the project by tomorrow.
(c) They said that they would completed the project by the next day.
(d) They said that they had completed the project by the next day.

29. She asked him why he had left early.
- (a) She said to him, "Why you left early?"
 - (b) She said to him, "Why did you leave early?"
 - (c) She said to him, "Why have you left early?"
 - (d) She said to him, "Why had you left early?"
30. She said that she was tired then.
- (a) She said, "I was tired then."
 - (b) She said, "I was tired now."
 - (c) She said, "I am tired then."
 - (d) She said, "I am tired now."

Direction (Question Nos. 31 - 60): Parts of speech:

31. In "The then governor addressed the crowd," the word **then** is:
- (a) Noun
 - (b) Adjective
 - (c) Adverb
 - (d) Preposition
32. Identify the part of speech of **round** in "The earth moves round the sun."
- (a) Noun
 - (b) Adverb
 - (c) Preposition
 - (d) Adjective
33. In "Enough is enough," the first **enough** is:
- (a) Pronoun
 - (b) Noun
 - (c) Adjective
 - (d) Adverb
34. In "She is too careful to err," the word **too** is:
- (a) Adjective
 - (b) Adverb
 - (c) Pronoun
 - (d) Preposition
35. Which sentence uses **after** as a conjunction?
- (a) He came after lunch.
 - (b) He ran after the thief.
 - (c) After he arrived, we ate.
 - (d) The after effects were severe.
36. Which sentence contains a relative pronoun?
- (a) Who are you?
 - (b) The man who came yesterday is my uncle.
 - (c) Who can solve this?
 - (d) Who! What a surprise.
37. In "He is anything but honest," the word **but** is:
- (a) Adverb
 - (b) Preposition
 - (c) Conjunction
 - (d) Pronoun
38. Identify the part of speech of **fast** in "**He drives fast.**"
- (a) Adjective
 - (b) Adverb
 - (c) Noun
 - (d) Pronoun
39. Which sentence uses **since** as a preposition?
- (a) Since you insist, I shall go.
 - (b) I have known him since 2010.
 - (c) It has changed since then.
 - (d) Since when were you waiting?

40. In "The accused was acquitted," the word **accused** is:
(a) Verb (b) Adjective used as noun
(c) Pronoun (d) Adverb
41. Identify the part of speech of **well** in "He is well."
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Noun (d) Verb
42. In the sentence "He is above cheating," the word **above** is:
(a) Adverb (b) Adjective
(c) Preposition (d) Conjunction
43. Identify the part of speech of **that** in the sentence "I know that he is honest."
(a) Demonstrative adjective (b) Relative pronoun
(c) Conjunction (d) Adverb
44. Which option contains an interrogative pronoun?
(a) Which book is yours? (b) Which is yours?
(c) I know which book is yours. (d) This book is yours.
45. Which sentence uses **like** as a conjunction?
(a) He looks like his father. (b) Nobody sings like she does.
(c) Children like sweets. (d) This seems like magic.
46. Which sentence contains a coordinating conjunction?
(a) Though he is poor, he is honest. (b) He tried hard but failed.
(c) If you work hard, you will succeed. (d) Because it rained, the match was cancelled.
47. Choose the sentence in which **before** functions as a preposition.
(a) Before he arrived, we left. (b) He arrived before noon.
(c) I had seen him before. (d) Before leaving, call me.
48. Which word functions as a **Pronoun** in: "*Many were invited, but few attended*".
(a) But (b) Invited
(c) Few (d) Attended
49. Which sentence contains a **Demonstrative Pronoun**?
(a) This book is mine. (b) This is mine.
(c) Such conduct is unacceptable. (d) Every student passed.
50. Select the sentence in which **round** is used as a preposition.
(a) The earth is round. (b) They sat round the table.
(c) He walked round and round. (d) We completed another round.
51. Which word is an **Adjective** in: "*A sleeping child looks peaceful*".
(a) Sleeping (b) Child
(c) Looks (d) None of these
52. Which sentence contains a **Relative Adverb**?
(a) Why are you late? (b) This is the place where I was born.
(c) When will you arrive? (d) How did it happen?

53. Which sentence contains a **Personal Pronoun**?
- (a) Those are expensive. (b) He completed the task.
(c) Which book is yours? (d) Everybody agreed.
54. Which sentence contains a **Proper Noun**?
- (a) The river is wide. (b) The boy is intelligent.
(c) Kolkata is a metropolitan city. (d) The mountain is high.
55. In "**He is above suspicion,**" *above* is:
- (a) Adverb (b) Conjunction
(c) Preposition (d) Noun
56. Identify the sentence in which **like** is used as a preposition.
- (a) Nobody sings like Lata Mangeshkar. (b) What is she like?
(c) I like classical music. (d) They would like to help.
57. Which sentence contains a **Common Noun**?
- (a) Honesty is essential. (b) Gold is valuable.
(c) The doctor arrived early. (d) Mumbai is crowded.
58. In the sentence "*The rich should help the poor,*" the word **rich** is:
- (a) Adjective used as Noun (b) Pronoun
(c) Adverb (d) Collective Noun
59. Which word is a **Preposition** in: "*The train passed through the tunnel*".
- (a) Passed (b) Through
(c) Tunnel (d) The
60. In the sentence "**He scarcely noticed the mistake**" the word **scarcely** is:
- (a) Adverb (b) Adjective
(c) Pronoun (d) Noun

Direction (Question Nos. (61 - 66): Choose the correct answer as directed for each question from the given options:

61. Choose the correct sentence.
- (a) Each of the boys have completed their work.
(b) Each of the boys has completed his work.
(c) Each of the boys have completed his work.
(d) Each of the boys has completed their work.
62. Select the correct usage.
- (a) He has been working here since five years.
(b) He has been working here for five years.
(c) He has worked here since five years.
(d) He is working here since five years.
63. "A person who hates mankind" is called:
- (a) Philanthropist (b) Optimist
(c) Misanthrope (d) Altruist

64. Choose the synonym of “**Transient**”.

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|---------------|---------------|
| (a) Permanent | (b) Temporary |
| (c) Honest | (d) Strong |

65. Choose the correct usage.

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|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| (a) He insisted to go. | (b) He insisted for going. |
| (c) He insisted on going. | (d) He insisted at going. |

66. Antonym of “**Mitigate**”:

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|---------------|------------|
| (a) Alleviate | (b) Ease |
| (c) Aggravate | (d) Reduce |

Section - B (Conventional Type Question) (34 Marks)

This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.

Marks are indicated against each question.

1. Make a precis of the following passage in about one-third of its original length. Supply a suitable title. (14)

The advent of social media has fundamentally altered the landscape of human communication and information exchange. What began as a platform for personal interaction has evolved into a powerful ecosystem that shapes public discourse, influences political processes, drives economic activity, and facilitates the dissemination of knowledge. Social media platforms have transcended geographical boundaries, enabled the rapid circulation of ideas and fostered unprecedented levels of connectivity. In an increasingly digital world, these platforms serve as important channels through which individuals, institutions, and governments engage with diverse audiences in real time.

The transformative potential of social media is evident in its capacity to democratize access to information. Educational institutions, libraries, research organizations, and public authorities utilize social media to disseminate knowledge, promote awareness, and encourage civic participation. During emergencies and public health crises, these platforms often function as vital communication tools, enabling the swift transmission of critical information. Furthermore, social media has amplified the voices of marginalized communities, creating opportunities for social advocacy and public engagement that were previously difficult to achieve through traditional media channels.

Despite these advantages, the proliferation of social media has generated significant challenges. The speed with which information travels often exceeds the mechanisms available for verification, contributing to the widespread circulation of misinformation and disinformation. The emergence of algorithm-driven content distribution can create echo chambers that reinforce existing beliefs and intensify social polarization. Additionally, concerns regarding data privacy, cybercrime, online harassment, and the commercialization of personal information have raised important ethical and legal questions. The influence of social media on public opinion and electoral processes has further highlighted the need for greater accountability and regulatory oversight.

In light of these developments, the effective use of social media requires a balanced approach that maximizes its benefits while mitigating its risks. Digital literacy, critical thinking, and responsible online conduct have become essential competencies for citizens of the twenty-first century. Governments, educational institutions, technology companies, and civil society must collaborate to promote ethical information practices and strengthen mechanisms for content verification. Ultimately, social media is neither inherently beneficial nor harmful; its impact depends on how individuals and societies choose to employ this powerful technological instrument. When guided by responsibility, transparency, and informed participation, social media can serve as a catalyst for knowledge dissemination, democratic engagement, and social progress.

2. You are the Chief Librarian of the High Court Library. Write a letter to the Secretary, Law & Judicial Department, emphasizing the need for establishing a Statewide Digital Legal Information Network connecting court libraries, law college libraries, and public legal information centres. Discuss its benefits for legal research, judicial efficiency, and public access to justice. (10)
3. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

The emergence of the knowledge economy has transformed the foundations of economic growth and social development. Unlike traditional economies that relied primarily on physical resources and manual labour, modern economies increasingly depend on the creation, dissemination, and application of knowledge. Information, innovation, and intellectual capital have become critical assets in determining productivity and competitiveness. In this context, libraries have evolved into important

institutions that facilitate access to knowledge and support the development of an informed and skilled society.

A defining feature of the knowledge economy is the importance of information accessibility. Access to reliable and timely information enables individuals to make informed decisions, acquire new skills, and participate effectively in economic and social activities. However, inequalities in access to information can widen existing social and economic disparities. Libraries help address this challenge by providing equitable access to authoritative sources of knowledge. Through their collections, digital resources, and community services, they promote educational opportunities and contribute to social inclusion.

The rapid advancement of digital technology has significantly expanded the role of libraries. Digital repositories, electronic databases, and online information services have extended library services beyond physical locations. At the same time, the abundance of information available through digital platforms has increased the risk of misinformation and information overload. Consequently, libraries have assumed a vital role in promoting information literacy. Librarians now guide users in identifying credible sources, evaluating information critically, and using information ethically and responsibly.

Libraries also constitute an essential component of a nation's knowledge infrastructure. By supporting research, innovation, and lifelong learning, they contribute to intellectual development and economic progress. Academic, legal, scientific, and public libraries provide access to specialized resources that facilitate scholarly inquiry and evidence-based decision-making. Despite challenges such as financial constraints, technological change, and evolving user expectations, libraries continue to adapt and remain relevant. As societies become increasingly knowledge-driven, libraries serve not only as repositories of information but also as dynamic institutions that empower individuals, strengthen communities, and promote sustainable development.

Answer the following questions given below:

- (a) What is meant by the term "knowledge economy"? (2)
- (b) How do libraries help reduce social and economic inequalities? (2)
- (c) Why is information literacy important in the digital age? (2)
- (d) How has digital technology simultaneously enhanced and complicated the role of libraries? (2)
- (e) Explain why libraries are described as an essential component of a nation's knowledge infrastructure. (2)

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